

Phil's Room

SEASON 4, PHIL'S LABORATORY, NIGHT

...

LUDOVICUS

I want no secrets. I want to know
exactly where my money is going to.
I want to know what is in the room.

Phil turns back to Ludovicus while busily writing in a report. Phil doesn't pay much attention to Ludovicus.

PHIL

Demon testing, I promise ya that.

LUDOVICUS

What's inside the room, Phil?

Phil still doesn't budge.

PHIL

...What room?

LUDOVICUS

THAT room. Don't play coy.-

Phil scoffs and finally lifts his head to speak to Ludovicus directly. His gaze already makes it obvious he finds Ludovicus' request silly.

PHIL

Room, room, what room? It's an old
factory. 5 acres full of goddamn
rooms. How the hell am I supposed
to know what "room" you're
referring to?

A silence falls. Then Phil bursts into laughter.

PHIL

Ah... I get it. You showed your
secret room, now I gotta show you
mine. Is that it?

LUDOVICUS

Your boss. I saw her by that heavy
door. The one with the locks.
Anyone would think a room that
guarded holds something valuable.
She was surveilling the place.
Looking at me like I saw something
I wasn't supposed to see. But she
didn't interfere.

She just gave me a nasty look and
that was my sign to walk off.

Phil frowns. He nods as he holds eye contact. He seems
bothered.

PHIL

"The room with the heavy door",
yea?

Ludovicus responds impatiently.

LUDOVICUS

Yes. What's it for?

Phil lowers his notebook besides his hip and turns his body
fully towards Ludovicus with his pencil in his other hand. He
has an annoyed expression and pauses before finally talking.

PHIL

...Demon testing. It's off limits.
Even my most trustworthy workers
aren't allowed in for contamination
reasons.

Phil sways his pencil in the air and points it at Ludovicus.

PHIL

You are no different, aha.

Phil burrows his head in his notebook again signaling
Ludovicus to end the conversation. Phil hovers his pencil
above the paper.

PHIL

Now get it out of ya mind.-
(His talking volume
decreases and his voice
softens.)

Ludovicus is quick to get annoyed by his tone and interrupts
him angrily.

LUDOVICUS

-Look here, you secretive, little
rat! I couldn't care less if the
most inhumane things are happening
in that room. I couldn't care less
if the things you do in that room,
my father isn't allowed to know of
because it would get you locked up
immediately.

I am ASKING you this because I am paying you absurd amounts of money to do what you do, something no other man can do.

PHIL IN FRAME AS LUDOVICUS TALKS

Phil is caught off guard and flustered at the same time. His big eyes beam at Ludovicus.

LUDOVICUS

-And even though you are that man, that awfully skilled and knowledgeable man, we are just as potent at cutting off your payment at this instant. Then none of us can enter the room.

Phil frowns and bites down firmly on his lollipop as his gaze intensifies.

PHIL

...Alright. Alright. I guess there really is no other way out of this then.

Phil points at Ludovicus reproachfully.

PHIL

But don't you ever compare my secrets to yours. They are incomparable!

Phil muffles a few words under his breath, as if he's feeling regretful of the situation.

PHIL'S SECRET ROOM, NIGHT

ZOOMED OUT

Ludovicus walks in front of Phil with the large entrance door opened behind them. Phil closes it. Their voices echo.

LUDOVICUS

All this fuzz for what, a... a greenhouse?

CAMERA ON LUDOVICUS

Ludovicus turns back to Phil.

LUDOVICUS

You either like gardening and it's
your super-secret hobby you're
deeply ashamed of, or you're
exporting illegal drugs.

Phil has his hands in his pockets. He tries giving as little
information as possible.

PHIL

There are no plants here.
(He masks his annoyance
with a forced relaxed
tone in his voice.)

Phil walks next to Ludovicus. Ludovicus walks to the rows of
trays of equipment and soil and scans across it with his
fingers while Phil talks. Ludovicus is mesmerized and not
paying much attention as his thoughts drift off.

PHIL

This is what you'd call our...
sample room. Temperature controlled
and hidden into the deepest layers
of the factory.

Ludovicus finds a tray of soil that catches his attention and
he stops walking.

PHIL

I don't know what you expected was
in here, -

Ludovicus quickly takes off his glove and puts his hand on
the soil and strokes it. Then he takes a handful.

PHIL

- so you might be let down not to
find a six-armed demon monster
freak experiment, or something just
as crazy, aha.

*CLOSE UP OF LUDOVICUS' FROWNING FACE LOOKING DOWN AT THE
SOIL. HE ZONES OUT. THEN SHOT OF THE SOIL FALLING THROUGH THE
GAPS OF HIS FINGERS.*

LUDOVICUS

I know what this is.

Ludovicus turns his head to Phil while still holding the soil in his hand above the tray.

LUDOVICUS
Where did you get Hell soil from?

PHIL
I know you know what it is. That is why I figured it wouldn't be interesting for you to come here.

He pauses.

PHIL
That specimen right there is quite old, aha. Taken from special demon hunter operations centuries ago. I myself am not too sure how they got it. One might wonder how they withstood such immense obstacles of pressure and heat to collect an amount this large...

LUDOVICUS
What do you do with it?

PHIL
Examining its compounds. Demon testings, like I said.

LUDOVICUS
I suppose studying demons also means studying the very soil they originated from...

Ludovicus shakes his fingers above the tray, getting rid of the soil sticking to his bare hand. However his hand remains stained.

PHIL
Precisely.
(laid back)

LUDOVICUS
So, do you?

PHIL
Do what?

LUDOVICUS
Make demons?

Phil inhales.

PHIL

In vain.

Phil walks closer to Ludovicus until he's standing next to him and the tray. His sophisticated footsteps give an industrial echo.

PHIL

...Y'see, this sample has lost all its interesting properties. Even with adjusted temperatures, this soil doesn't make demons on its own. It houses them. Then develops them, aha. We are still figuring that out.

Phil points his finger at the tray and shakes his arm confidently.

PHIL

So that, right there, that's where the money's goin'.

He puts his hand back in his pocket.

LUDOVICUS

You would tell me... if you made a demon. Would you, Phil?

PHIL

...You would know before I'd even have the chance to tell you.

Phil times his smile poorly. His confident mask nearly slips off.

QUICK CLOSE UP OF LUDOVICUS' BACK SUDDENLY BEING PATTED BY PHIL. THE NOISE OF THE PAT IS TURNED UP. IMMEDIATELY GOES BACK TO PREVIOUS SHOT OF LUDOVICUS.

LUDOVICUS

Very well...

Ludovicus sticks out his hand to Phil. The same dirtied hand he touched the soil with. Phil shakes his hand powerfully.

CLOSE UP OF HANDSHAKE

PHIL

You can expect nothing but honest work from my part, Ludovicus.